

FlexMatch – From Uncertainty to Opportunity: A Hyper-Local Platform for Flexible Short-Term Work through Lean Startup Experimentation

Idea and Opportunity Development



The report is prepared by:

Mikkel Brøsted Nielsen

17.01.1997, DDBD, 1. Semester

Tancredi Calogero Piscitello

13.12.2001, DDBD, 2. Semester

Rasmus Nørgaard Larsen

22.06.1997, DDBD, 2. Semester

Ruyi Zhong

17.01.1997, DDBD, 2. Semester

Supervisor / examiner:

Mette Søggaard Nielsen

Institut for Erhverv og Bæredygtighed

Suna Løwe Nielsen

Institut for Erhverv og Bæredygtighed

Sworn statement

We hereby solemnly declare that I have personally and independently prepared this paper. All quotations in the text have been marked as such, and the paper or considerable parts of it have not previously been subject to any examination or assessment.

Mikkel Brøsted Nielsen

Tancredi Calogero Piscitello

Rasmus Nørgaard Larsen

Ruyi Zhong

Contents

1A. Overview of Data on Trends to Identify Needs/Problems	1
1B. Validate the identified needs/problems and show data collection and validation.....	3
Interview Findings.....	3
Survey Findings.....	4
Fake-Door Experiment	6
1C. Reframe the problems and explore the opportunity space	6
1D. Lean Startup Process and Prototyping.....	8
Rationale Behind the Prototype Development	9
Lean Startup Methodology and Build, Measure, Learn Cycle	9
Build – Assumptions, hypotheses, minimum viable product and experiments	10
Assumptions and Hypotheses	10
Observational research text for Experiments/MVP section.....	12
Minimum Viable Product (MVP) Design and Purpose	12
Minimum Viable Product (MVP) Experiments	13
Measurement and Learning	14
Finding 1: MVP 1 identified the exact problems existing channels cannot solve.....	14
Finding 2: MVP 2 refined the matching process and algorithm logic	15
Finding 3: Price affects response, but price must be part of a wider platform pricing logic	16
Reflection: Pivot, Persevere, or Perish.....	17
1E. Business Opportunity and Business Model Canvas	18
The Opportunity	19
How It Addresses the Identified Need	19
Value Proposition and Profitability	19

2A. Reflection on uncertainty.....	21
2B. Entrepreneurial decision-making logics	21
Decision-making logic influences our project.....	26
2C. Reflection on Team Process	28
Team composition and personality diversity	28
Contributions to the entrepreneurial process.....	28
Decision-making under uncertainty.....	29
Team cohesion and productive conflict	29
Collaboration and adaptation.....	30
The role of the individual within the team.....	30
List of References	31
List of Appendices.....	33
Appendix 1b-01. Job Poster Interview Summary	33
Appendix 1b-02: Job Seeker Interview Summary.....	35
Appendix 1b-03: Fake-Door Experiment Summary	37
Appendix 1d-01. Prototype illustrations and platform concept designs	39
Appendix 1d-02. Assumptions vs. prototype mapping table	41
Appendix 1d-03. Summary of MVP Learnings and Prototype Adjustments	42
Appendix 1d-04. MVP data collection sheets, post views, and follow-up interview transcripts	43

1A. Overview of Data on Trends to Identify Needs/Problems

In this section, we are going to conduct an analysis to explore trends within flexible work, on-demand services and everyday task outsourcing in urban environments.

According to recent statistical data, there has been an increase in flexible employment models. For example, in the USA, around 36% of the workforce currently participates in the gig economy or engages in independent work (McKinsey, 2023).

This trend appears to be expanding in other markets as well (including the European one) and it is projected to grow significantly in the near term, leading to a structural transformation of employment models.

The global demand for temporary digital labour is also showing consistent growth: the rise of “platform economy” (for instance, “Wolt”, “Ubereats”, etc.) demonstrates that the need to outsource short-term tasks corresponds to a real market demand, fundamentally changing how everyday services are accessed and managed (World Economic Forum, 2024).

Consumers are looking for immediate and practical solutions for their needs while businesses increasingly rely on occasional workers to manage internal demand fluctuations.

It is important to highlight that this macro-trend of looking for occasional, flexible, temporary jobs, from the side of the worker, is not merely driven by immediate financial necessity or economic urgency. A significant segment of this market consists of university students and independent individuals who experience unpredictable blocks of free time during the week and actively seek to use these hours productively. Academic literature highlights that the flexible labor supply increasingly includes individuals who use digital platforms to fill gaps in their daily schedules, seeking autonomy and personal productivity beyond simple economic returns (Schor et al., 2020).

This motivation represents a distinct layer of the trend, where the desire to avoid boredom and engage in short-term practical activities aligns with the broader shift of society toward on-demand services.

However, although the gig economy is growing rapidly, the expansion of flexible work does not automatically equal access to stable, safe and quality employment. The current system is aggravating entry problems rather than solving them. Those seeking flexibility often face severe income instability and difficulty finding consistent opportunities suited to their skills. In-depth research shows that even if occasional workers appreciate independence, one in four workers reports being partially or completely dissatisfied with their income level and associated benefits (World Economic Forum, 2024). Specific studies conducted on hundreds of gig economy

workers show that over three-quarters of respondents experience high levels of insecurity and anxiety regarding labor protections, and 28% perceive concrete risks to their health or safety while performing tasks (University of Bristol, 2023). Existing platforms for outsourcing tasks often prove too slow to respond, too generic, or poorly structured to meet immediate, local needs.

We conducted primary qualitative research through interviews with potential job seekers to verify all the data found so far in the articles. The findings of the interviews conducted demonstrate that indeed, while some participants are driven by sudden financial deficits, such as needing short-term money to pay rent, others primarily look for ways to stay productive during empty moments in their weekly routine. There is a strong preference for low-stress, social tasks, such as distributing flyers with a friend, supporting local events, or performing basic administrative duties. We found out, additionally, that these temporary jobs are also seen as valuable networking opportunities that would ultimately and ideally lead to a desired full-time career. For example, temporarily working in an event organized by a company of interest, according to some interviewees, could eventually lead them to meet people that would help them get an interview for the job they want.

The interview findings, however, reflect also the previously mentioned frustration and anxiety of the workers with the current platforms.

A major problem with existing systems lies in payment delays. Despite the urgent need for money expressed by several respondents, salaries are often paid after a month or a month and a half due to corporate billing cycles, canceling the fundamental value of short-term occasional work. For students wishing to fill short time gaps, the barriers are operational. Temporary work agencies prioritize their own corporate needs and provide very short notice, confirming shifts late at night for the following morning. This forces students to miss mandatory university classes, creating a frustrating dynamic where the platform retains total control over scheduling. Local jobs on current platforms are also heavily restricted to intense manual labor in warehouses or restaurants, failing to offer the variety of light tasks that students prefer. Short-term work only becomes rewarding when there is transparency, clear rules and mutual trust between the worker and the organization. Interviewees emphasized the importance of knowing exactly who is behind the job offer to feel safe and respected.

These trends highlight a deep structural problem in the market. In a world where both the demand for flexible help and the supply of available workers is increasing, a fundamental inefficiency remains in connecting the two parties in real time. Current systems do not provide fast, reliable and low-friction matching. This disconnection means that access to platforms does not guarantee an appropriate match, and having free time does not ensure finding a suitable task. This results in delays and uncertainty for those needing help, and instability or operational

friction for workers. Both financially pressured individuals and underutilized students lack a transparent, hyper-local platform capable of offering truly flexible tasks, with immediate payments and clear rules.

1B. Validate the identified needs/problems and show data collection and validation

Interview Findings

This study looks at how organizations experience short-term staffing shortages during periods with fluctuating demand and uncertainty. Across all three interviews, staffing problems were not described as isolated incidents, but more as a result of increasingly unpredictable business environments.

One of the main findings from the interviews was that unpredictability is a major operational challenge. Even though the participants operate in different industries, they all described demand patterns that are difficult to predict accurately. One participant explained that “sometimes it’s just busier than expected,” while another described how “some nights are quiet, others are very busy.” The DJ company owner also explained that bookings sometimes arrive “with about two days’ notice, which makes it difficult to plan staffing needs in advance.

The interviews also showed that staffing shortages are not only about a lack of workers. Reliability, trust, and adaptability also seemed to matter a lot for the businesses. Several participants expressed frustration toward external workers because they were unfamiliar with routines and standards. One participant explained that “technically they might be fine, but they don’t always match how we usually do things,” while another stated that temporary workers “needed quite a bit of direction.” This suggests that businesses need workers who can quickly adapt to existing workflows and routines.

Another thing that appeared multiple times in the interviews was that businesses often tried solving the problem internally instead of relying on outside workers. Instead of depending on agencies or freelancers, participants often redistributed tasks internally, accepted lower efficiency, or handled the workload themselves. One participant explained that “someone else has to take on more work,” while another stated, “I went into the kitchen myself.” This could indicate that businesses trust their own employees more than temporary workers, even if it creates more pressure internally.

Time pressure also seemed to play an important role in staffing decisions. Although external workers may technically be available, participants repeatedly explained that urgent situations leave very little time for onboarding or supervision. The restaurant owner explained that “during a rush, we don’t have that time,”

referring to the time required to guide temporary workers. Because of this, external workers become less useful in highly time-sensitive situations.

The interviews also revealed broader consequences of staffing instability. Across all cases, shortages affected productivity, employee well-being, customer experience, and long-term business performance. One participant explained that “customers wait longer, and the team gets stressed,” while another warned that dissatisfied customers “might not come back.” The DJ company owner also highlighted reputational risks related to inconsistent staffing, explaining that he sometimes rejects opportunities because he is “not confident” the company can maintain its standards.

Overall, the interviews indicate that modern staffing challenges reflect a mismatch between volatile demand patterns and existing workforce models. Businesses increasingly operate in environments that require flexibility and quick responsiveness, while existing labor solutions often fail to provide the reliability and adaptability businesses need.

Although the study is based on a limited qualitative sample and therefore cannot be generalized statistically, the findings still provide useful insight into how organizations experience staffing volatility in practice. More importantly, the analysis suggests that short-term labor challenges are not simply resource problems, but also coordination problems shaped by uncertainty and trust.

Survey Findings

This study investigates how individuals perceive and engage with short-term and flexible work opportunities in the current labor market. The findings suggest that while there is clear interest in flexible micro-work, existing labor platforms and temporary employment structures often fail to meet workers’ expectations regarding transparency, predictability, and trust.

One of the main findings was that short-term work is mainly driven by financial motivation, although money is not the only reason people participate in flexible labor markets. One participant stated that the main motivation was “money, of course money,” especially regarding immediate expenses. However, the same participant also mentioned networking opportunities and cultural integration as additional motivations. This suggests that flexible work is not only viewed as supplementary income, but also as a way to create future opportunities.

The findings also showed that many individuals have fragmented or underutilized periods of free time that could potentially be used for micro-jobs. Participants described recurring periods of free time during afternoons or

weekends where they wanted to do something more productive. One respondent explained that they had “so much time free now and I want to do something productive,” while another described searching for event-based work simply due to boredom during weekends.

At the same time, the interviews revealed dissatisfaction with current temporary work arrangements. One recurring issue was the lack of transparency regarding job expectations and working conditions. One participant described arriving at a warehouse job only to discover that the tasks and workload were very different from expectations. The participant explained that “what I was supposed to do was very unclear,” while also criticizing delayed salary payments and poorer conditions compared to permanent employees.

In contrast, positive experiences were often connected to clarity and professionalism. One participant described a short-term social media management role positively because the company clearly communicated “what I had to do, the time that I had, and how much time I had to spend on each task.” Participants generally interpreted this transparency as a sign of professionalism and respect.

Another important finding concerns trust and reputability in workers’ decision-making processes. Participants repeatedly emphasized that the legitimacy of the employer strongly influenced whether they were willing to accept tasks. One participant explained, “I don’t focus a lot on what actually the tasks are, I want to know who’s behind the tasks,” while later adding, “I need to trust what you’re saying and what you’re showing.” This suggests that trust functions as an important filter in flexible labor markets.

The interviews also revealed a tension between flexibility and predictability. Although respondents liked the possibility of choosing when to work, they also expressed a strong need for advance notice and scheduling clarity. One participant criticized employers for confirming shifts only a few hours before work began, explaining that this disrupted university classes and personal planning. Another participant emphasized the need for “at least like 10–12 hours” of notice before starting a task.

The findings additionally indicate that existing platforms struggle to accommodate truly short-duration work. Participants explained that many systems categorize “short-term” work too broadly, making it difficult to match workers seeking micro-tasks with employers needing immediate assistance. One respondent explained that “for somebody short terms can be two days, three days, five days, for somebody else it can be just one day.”

Overall, the findings suggest that the main challenge within flexible labor markets is not necessarily a lack of willingness to work, but more issues related to trust, communication, transparency, and coordination. Workers

are generally open to short-term opportunities when tasks are clearly communicated and compatible with existing schedules.

Although the study is based on a limited qualitative sample and therefore cannot be generalized statistically, the findings still provide insight into how workers experience gig and temporary labor markets in practice.

Fake-Door Experiment

The analysis of the fake-door experiment, Google Analytics data, and user submissions provides evidence of demand for a flexible micro-job platform operating within short-term labor markets. Across a 41-day campaign period conducted without paid advertising, the platform generated 82 submissions and achieved a page-view-to-submission conversion rate of 81.2%, which indicates relatively strong interest from users.

Importantly, both labor demand and labor supply emerged organically through the same QR-based campaign structure, showing natural self-selection into the two-sided marketplace model. The findings suggest that labor supply currently exceeds labor demand, with 54 job seekers compared to 28 job posters. This is strategically favorable during the early stages of development because having too few workers available is often more problematic than having limited demand.

The data also showed that job seekers possess fragmented or unused time capacity and are willing to engage in flexible work opportunities, especially when tasks are geographically convenient, transparent, and quickly accessible.

The geographical findings also support the platform hypothesis. Large cities such as Copenhagen and Aarhus generated the highest browsing activity and repeated visits, indicating interest in gig-economy services. In contrast, cities such as Kolding, Horsens, Fredericia, and Vejle produced stronger submission conversion rates, suggesting more immediate operational demand in these areas.

Overall, the experiment validates the existence of both supply-side and demand-side interest in flexible micro-work. More importantly, the findings indicate that the biggest challenge is probably not market willingness, but more about coordinating trust, pricing, speed, and matching between workers and businesses.

1C. Reframe the problems and explore the opportunity space

The initial problem formulation — “we believe businesses experience difficulties with covering short-term jobs” — framed the issue mainly as a staffing shortage problem. While the interviews and market validation data partly

support this assumption, the findings suggest that the problem is more complex than simply lacking available workers.

Using ideas from design thinking and reframing theory, especially Bianchi and Verganti (2021), the problem can therefore be understood as more than just a staffing issue. It also seems connected to trust, uncertainty, and coordination between workers and businesses.

From a traditional opportunity discovery perspective, the labor market appears to contain an observable inefficiency: businesses struggle to fill urgent short-term positions while many individuals simultaneously possess fragmented free time and willingness to work. This interpretation aligns with the Kirznerian perspective, where entrepreneurial opportunities emerge through identifying market imbalances. (Kirzner, 1973) The fake-door experiment strongly supports this perspective because both labor demand and labor supply emerged organically through the platform concept.

However, the interviews also reveal that the issue cannot only be reduced to labor scarcity. Businesses repeatedly emphasized that available workers are often perceived as operationally insufficient due to limited contextual understanding, onboarding requirements, and concerns regarding reliability. Several participants explained that external workers “don’t really know how we work here” and “need quite a bit of direction,” especially during high-pressure situations where there is limited time for training.

Applying problem expansion broadens the understanding of the challenge further. Initially, the problem seems to concern employers and workers only. However, expanding the frame reveals a larger system involving scheduling uncertainty, fragmented labor markets, platform structures, customer expectations, and broader cultural shifts toward flexibility and immediacy.

The problem therefore expands from being about “covering short-term jobs” to becoming more of a coordination problem between uncertainty, trust, and flexible labor availability.

Problem elevation also deepens this reframing by asking why the issue matters beyond operational inefficiency. At a surface level, staffing shortages create stress, delays, and reduced productivity. However, the interviews reveal deeper organizational and human themes. For businesses, staffing instability threatens reliability, service quality, reputation, and organizational control. For workers, uncertainty regarding tasks, employers, and scheduling affects trust, security, and fairness.

At a deeper level, the issue is therefore not only about staffing, but also about reducing uncertainty in fragmented and time-sensitive labor interactions. The challenge concerns how trust can be established quickly between actors who often have no prior relationship and limited time for evaluation.

Rather than framing the opportunity as a platform that simply “fills shifts,” the opportunity may instead lie in designing systems that create trust and faster integration under uncertain conditions.

Consequently, the reframed problem hypothesis is formulated as:

Businesses operating under unpredictable and time-sensitive conditions struggle not only with accessing labor, but also with establishing trustworthy and reliable workforce. At the same time, workers seek flexible earning opportunities that still provide predictability, transparency, and trust. However, existing labor systems often fail to coordinate these needs efficiently, creating friction between flexibility and operational reliability.

This reframing shifts the focus away from labor shortages alone and toward the broader tension between flexibility, trust, speed, and coordination in modern labor markets.

1D. Lean Startup Process and Prototyping

From previous trend analysis, interviews, and fake door research, we have already confirmed the existing demand for urgent job helpers, as well as the demand for more flexible jobs and extra earning opportunities. Based on these findings, the key problem has also been identified and reframed. Therefore, we developed a related prototype to solve this problem.

The Lean Startup methodology is used to examine whether the proposed prototype mechanisms can solve the problem more effectively than existing solutions. The purpose of using the Lean Startup methodology is to reduce uncertainty through iterative experimentation and behavioural validation, so that the proposed prototype can address the problem directly. This aligns with Blank’s (2013) argument that startups should prioritize experimentation, customer feedback, and iterative learning over detailed upfront planning.

The whole process includes identifying critical assumptions from the prototype, transforming these assumptions into measurable hypotheses, testing them through low-cost experiments, and finally summarizing the results to refine the business model. At the same time, the prototype can be understood as a designed entrepreneurial artifact, where its value depends on how well its mechanisms fit the environment in which it is expected to operate, such as urgent, local, and trust-based task matching (Berglund, 2021).

Rationale Behind the Prototype Development

A prototype, the FlexMatch platform, was designed after problem reframe. The purpose of prototype is to visualize and test the core value proposition in the business model.

Based on the initial insights from previous research and analysis, the initial prototype was designed as a platform connecting job posters and job seeks. The concept of the idea reflects a typical form of entrepreneurship in which value is created by connecting two groups of people who would otherwise not know or easily reach each other. The initial prototype includes fast GPS-based job recommendations, a focus on short-term micro-jobs, centralized coordination between job posters and job seekers, and administrative support such as payment, contract, and payroll handling. (Nielsen, 2026)

The idea of focusing on short-term urgent tasks comes out from our target market, where the current existing job platform uncovered. It differentiates us from traditional job platforms as well as aligns with the previous research on trends and problems. Due to the target market, GPS function and centralized coordination between job posters as well as job seekers were included in initial prototype, it will be the foundation of how to fulfil the quick match requirements for our targeting market. In addition, the platform also aimed to reduce administrative burden for small and medium-sized businesses. It is due to the consideration of earlier interviews' results, where suggested that temporary staffing problems are not only about labor shortages, but also about coordination, reliability, and administration.

The prototype illustrations and platform concept designs are included in the appendix 1d-01. Based on this prototype, the next section identifies the key assumptions that need to be tested through the Lean Startup methodology.

Lean Startup Methodology and Build, Measure, Learn Cycle

Although the prototype was developed based on previous research and problem reframing, several key assumptions still needed to be tested. These assumptions were mainly related to whether the proposed platform could improve urgent matching efficiency, support more structured communication, increase trust, reduce coordination problems, and create enough value for users to accept the service.

Therefore, the Build–Measure–Learn cycle was used to guide the testing process. In the Build stage, the assumptions were translated into MVPs and low-cost experiments. In the Measure stage, behavioral data and

user feedback were collected. In the Learn stage, the results were used to evaluate and refine the prototype, matching logic, and business model.

Build – Assumptions, hypotheses, minimum viable product and experiments

Assumptions and Hypotheses

In the Build stage, the first step was to connect the prototype mechanisms with specific assumptions that could be tested. The Assumptions vs prototype mapping table is in appendix 1d-02.

Few key assumptions were involved in the MVP tests. First, because the prototype emphasized fast and urgent matching, we assumed that existing channels such as Facebook groups create delays, fragmented communication, and weak candidate filtering. Second, because the prototype used GPS-based recommendations, we assumed that location and proximity would influence response speed and applicant suitability. Third, because the prototype aimed to create a more structured matching process, we assumed that structured applicant information and platform-based communication would improve filtering, reduce privacy concerns, and make candidate selection easier. Fourth, because trust was identified as important in earlier interviews, we assumed that trust signals, ratings, reliability indicators, and clearer task descriptions would improve matching quality. Finally, because the prototype aimed to become a workable business model, we assumed that job posters may be willing to pay for faster and more reliable matching, and that payroll, payment, or contract handling could create additional value.

These assumptions were then translated into measurable hypotheses and tested through observational research, fake door data, MVP experiments, and follow-up interviews. This helped ensure that the MVP experiments were not only used to demonstrate the idea, but also to collect evidence about the most important parts of the proposed platform. Each assumption was therefore linked to specific indicators that could be observed and evaluated during the experiments as below:

Assumption	Measurable Hypothesis	Validation Test / Method	What Was Measured
Current platforms are operationally inefficient	Existing channels create delays and fragmented coordination during urgent matching	MVP 1 manual Facebook matching + observational research	Response time, communication channels used, post approval delays

Assumption	Measurable Hypothesis	Validation Test / Method	What Was Measured
Existing Facebook groups serve a similar purpose but are not designed for small individual urgent tasks	Relevant job/help groups exist, but many mainly support company job posts or agency recruitment rather than small private tasks	Observational research + MVP 1 posting experience	Group type, post content, admin approval/rejection, share of company/agency posts
Existing systems are shaped by companies and job agents	Many posts are made by companies or job agencies, limiting suitability for informal micro-tasks	Observational research	Share of posts from agencies such as Hotjob ApS, Jobteam, JKS, etc.
Faster visibility improves matching efficiency	Faster task exposure increases the possibility of quicker applicant responses	MVP 1 manual matching	Time until post became visible; time until first response
Structured communication improves candidate filtering	Structured applicant information makes worker comparison and selection easier	MVP 2 structured third-party matching	Application completeness, ease of filtering, candidate comparison
Trust improves matching quality	Trust-enhanced task descriptions and third-party filtering generate more reliable candidates	MVP 2 structured/trust-based post + follow-up interview	Willingness to share information, perceived reliability, trust score, job poster feedback
Job posters are willing to pay for faster and more reliable matching	Job posters accept a small extra fee if the service saves time and improves reliability	Fake door form + MVP 1 and MVP 2 follow-up interviews	Price expectations, willingness to pay, commission acceptance, qualitative feedback
Small financial incentives motivate participation	Workers still apply for low-paid short-term tasks, but response speed and quality may decrease	MVP 1 low-paid task + MVP 3 pricing sensitivity test	Number of applicants, response speed, applicant quality at different pay levels
Location-based tasks improve response behaviour	Nearby applicants respond faster and are more suitable for urgent tasks	MVP 1, MVP 2, and MVP 3 applicant location comparison	Applicant location, distance from task, response speed, selected/shortlisted candidates
Users prefer platform interaction over personal social media interaction	Structured third-party/platform communication reduces privacy concerns and coordination friction	MVP 1 communication observation + MVP 2 third-party matching interview	Communication channels used, privacy concerns, job poster feedback
Payroll and contract handling create additional value	Businesses perceive platform-managed payment, agreement, or payroll handling as increasing security and professionalism	Job poster interviews + prototype feedback + MVP 2 follow-up interview	Interview feedback, perceived professionalism, willingness to use platform-managed agreement/payment

Table 1- Assumption vs Hypotheses

Observational research text for Experiments/MVP section

Before conducting the manual MVPs, observational research was carried out in existing Facebook groups that appeared to serve a similar purpose to the proposed platform, such as groups for people seeking jobs or employers seeking workers. The purpose was to understand how current informal matching channels function in practice and whether they could already solve the problem addressed by the prototype.

The observation showed that relevant groups, such as søger arbejds/søger medarbejder, do exist. However, these groups were not fully suitable for the type of small, urgent, individual tasks targeted by our platform. Many groups mainly served companies, formal employers, or recruitment agencies rather than private individuals needing short-term help. When we attempted to post small individual tasks, some posts were delayed or not approved by administrators, which showed that these channels are not optimized for urgent micro-task matching.

Another finding was that a large share of posts was made by job agents or staffing companies, such as Hotjob ApS, Jobteam, and JKS. This suggests that the existing Facebook ecosystem is partly dominated by formal recruitment actors, while quick private tasks can become less visible or less accepted. Therefore, the observational research supported the assumption that existing channels may serve a related purpose, but they do not fully address the need for fast, low-friction, location-based matching between private job posters and flexible workers.

Minimum Viable Product (MVP) Design and Purpose

To validate the platform assumptions, three MVPs were designed to test the most critical assumptions behind the prototype and improve the future matching logic of the platform. Each MVP focused on specific uncertainties related to coordination, trust, and participation behavior as below table.

MVP	Design Goal	Hypotheses Connected	Prototype Link
MVP 1: Manual Facebook Matching	To identify the specific operational problems in existing Facebook-based matching channels and understand what FlexMatch must improve.	Existing channels create delays and fragmented coordination; Facebook groups are not designed for small urgent individual tasks; faster visibility improves matching efficiency; platform-based communication may reduce friction.	This MVP helped define what the prototype must add beyond Facebook: instant task visibility, centralized communication, structured applicant information, location/availability filtering, and candidate comparison.

MVP	Design Goal	Hypotheses Connected	Prototype Link
MVP 2: Structured Matching	To test whether a structured third-party matching process could improve candidate comparison and refine the future matching algorithm.	Structured applicant information improves filtering; trust improves matching quality; location-based tasks improve response behaviour; platform-based communication reduces privacy and coordination friction.	This MVP refined the prototype's matching logic from simple GPS-based matching into multi-factor matching based on availability, location, reliability, task fit, experience, and response completeness.
MVP 3: Pricing Sensitivity	To test how payment level influences job seeker response behaviour and how pricing should support matching logic and business-model feasibility.	Small financial incentives motivate participation; job posters may pay for faster and more reliable matching; location still affects suitability; price influences response speed but may not guarantee match quality.	This MVP refined the prototype by adding pricing recommendation logic, urgency pricing, and possible commission logic, while showing that price should support the matching algorithm rather than replace it.

Table 2– MVP Design

Minimum Viable Product (MVP) Experiments

The MVP experiments were conducted in real Facebook job/help groups in order to observe actual behavior rather than only stated opinions. The detailed data collection sheets, post views, and follow-up interview transcripts are included in the appendix.

To summarize how each MVP was conducted and measured, the experiment overview is presented below.

MVP	Experiment Setup	What Was Tested / Measured
MVP 1	A cat-sitting task was posted in four Facebook groups. The team manually handled posting, communication, applicant filtering, and follow-up.	Post visibility delay, admin approval, communication channels, applicant information quality, response speed, location relevance, filtering difficulty, and job requester feedback.
MVP 2	A structured moving-helper task was posted at 120 DKK/hour. The team collected comparable applicant information and recommended candidates to the job poster.	Structured task post, required applicant information, third-party filtering, candidate comparison, trust score, usability of applicants, and follow-up interview with the job poster.
MVP 3	The same moving-helper task was tested at 50, 120, and 200 DKK/hour, combined with fake-door price data and follow-up interviews.	Applicant quantity, response speed, usable candidates, different price levels, fake-door price ranges, commission acceptance, and acceptable hourly pay.

Table 3– MVP Measurement

For **MVP 1**, a cat-sitting task in Horsens was posted in four relevant Facebook groups. We acted as a third-party matcher by posting the task, collecting responses, observing visibility delays, recording communication channels,

and filtering applicants based on location, availability, and pet experience. The purpose was to experience the current matching process directly and identify the exact friction points that the prototype should solve.

For **MVP 2**, a moving-helper task in Fredericia was posted at 120 DKK/hour using a more structured format. The post included task description, time, location, payment, requirements, and clear application instructions. Applicants were asked to provide availability, location, moving or physical work experience, and a short introduction. The team then compared applicants manually and recommended suitable candidates to the job poster. This experiment simulated how a future platform algorithm might collect, filter, and rank candidates.

For **MVP 3**, the same moving-helper task was tested at three different hourly prices: 50, 120, and 200 DKK/hour. The task format, location, time, and requirements were kept as same, while the price was changed. This allowed us to compare applicant quantity, response speed, and applicant usability across different payment levels. MVP 3 was also connected to the earlier fake-door analysis, where job posters had indicated different willingness-to-pay ranges for tasks and instant matching, while job seekers had provided expected earnings. In addition, follow-up interviews were conducted with both job posters and job seekers to understand how they interpreted pricing, acceptable hourly pay, and possible commission from the job poster side.

Measurement and Learning

Finding 1: MVP 1 identified the exact problems existing channels cannot solve

MVP 1 aligned with the prototype assumption that FlexMatch should be faster and more suitable for urgent local micro-tasks than existing informal channels. It also aligned with the hypotheses that current platforms are operationally inefficient, Facebook groups are not designed for small individual urgent tasks, faster visibility improves matching efficiency, and platform-based communication may reduce coordination friction.

The result of MVP1 shows that existed platform is not sufficient for our targets, urgent tasks. As shown in Figure below, the average visibility delay is 565,7 minutes, the median response after the post visible is 130 minutes while the average response time after posting is 1058,1 minutes. It is caused by admin approval delays, fragmented communication across comments/private messages/friend requests, inconsistent applicant information, privacy barriers, and weak filtering as below table state.

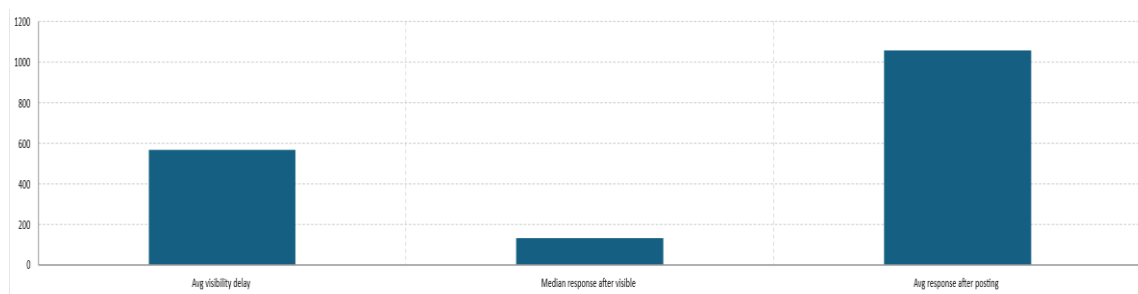


Figure 1 – MVP 1 – Facebook friction delays

At the same time, observational research also showed that many relevant groups are shaped by companies, job agents, and recruitment actors rather than small private urgent tasks. Thus, we conclude that the existed platforms, neither Facebook or job agents are not sufficient for our target market. At the same time, it also reflected that the initial prototype should reduce Facebook-style friction through instant task visibility, centralized communication, structured applicant information, and location availability filtering or traceability.

Finding 2: MVP 2 refined the matching process and algorithm logic

MVP 2 aligned with the prototype idea that the matching algorithm would become one of FlexMatch’s key value propositions. It also aligned with the hypotheses that structured communication improves candidate filtering, trust improves matching quality, location-based tasks improve response behavior, and platform-based communication reduces coordination friction.

The experiment was designed to simulate how a future platform might collect, filter, and rank candidates. A structured moving-helper post asked applicants to provide location, availability, moving/physical work experience, and a short introduction. This allowed the team to compare candidates through common criteria instead of scattered Facebook messages. The follow-up interview with the job poster then helped clarify which criteria mattered most in the matching decision.

The result supports the prototype by showing that the algorithm should not only be GPS-based. It should become a multi-factor matching algorithm using distance from task, confirmed availability, task-relevant experience, response completeness, reliability/trust score, physical ability or skill fit, and job poster preference. Therefore, MVP 2 refined the prototype from simple GPS matching into multi-factor ranking based on availability, location, reliability, task fit, and response completeness.

Finding 3: Price affects response, but price must be part of a wider platform pricing logic

MVP 3 result combined with the data collection of price expectation in fake-door research aligned with the assumptions that small financial incentives motivate participation, job posters are willing to pay for faster and more reliable matching, and location-based tasks improve response behavior. At same time, it confirmed our assumption of business profitability.

As shown in the figures, higher pay increased applicant quantity and reduced response time. The 50 DKK/hour post received 6 applicants, but only 1 usable applicant, with an average response time of 176.2 minutes. The 120 DKK/hour post received 9 applicants, with 4 usable applicants, and an average response time of 104.7 minutes. The 200 DKK/hour post received the most attention, with 11 applicants and the fastest average response time of 76.8 minutes, but still only 4 usable applicants. It suggests that higher pay can attract faster and more responses, but it does not proportionally improve applicant quality.

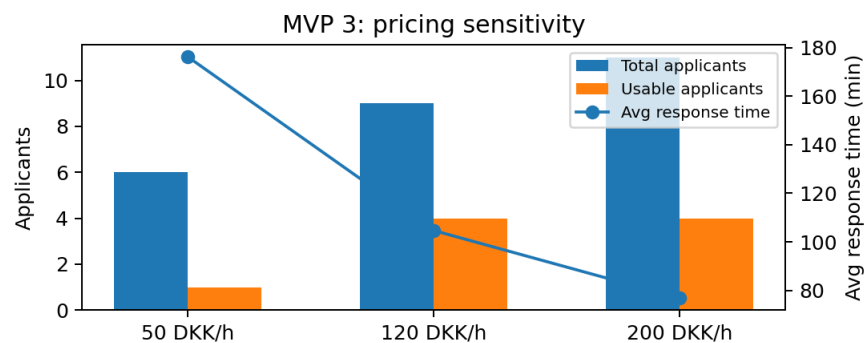


Figure 2 – MVP 3 Price Sensitivity

Combined with the fake-door price data shown in Figure below, MVP 3 indicates potential profitability through commission or service fees from job posters. The data shows that job posters were willing to pay not only for the task itself (On average 190DKK), but also for faster matching (On average 65.6DKK). At the same time, job seekers' expected earnings varied between 50 and 200 DKK/hour (On average 112.1DKK), which suggests that pricing expectations are flexible and may need platform guidance. Therefore, faster and more reliable matching could create additional value, supporting a possible commission-based or urgency-fee business model. And there is possibility that the platform can be profitable via commission-based job posts.

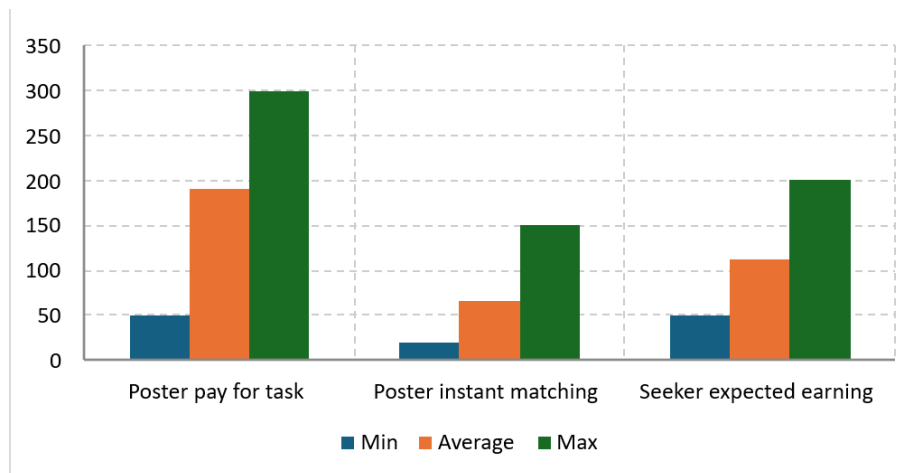


Figure 3 – Fake door price expectation range

The follow-up interviews added further interpretation. Job seekers explained that acceptable price depends on task duration and convenience. A very easy task, for example a 10-minute task on the way home, may work with a small, fixed payment. However, one-to-four-hour tasks should normally be paid hourly, around 100–150 DKK/hour, while half-day or full-day tasks should also be hourly and may require clearer conditions, especially when posted by companies.

Overall, with the feedback from follow up interview, MVP test results as well as data collection from fake door research, FlexMatch could apply a success-based commission model. A 5–10% commission appears suitable for ordinary private tasks needed match within a week, while 12–15% may be reasonable for urgent tasks posted from companies where the platform provides faster matching and stronger filtering. For very small micro-tasks, a fixed service fee could be used instead.

To summarize how the MVP learnings refined the prototype, the key alignment between prototype mechanisms, tested hypotheses, and platform adjustments is shown in appendix 1D-03 Summary of MVP Learnings and Prototype Adjustments.

Reflection: Pivot, Persevere, or Perish

Based on the research and MVP tests, the core idea should be kept for further development, because the findings indicate a market gap for urgent job and task matching. However, before further investment, the initial prototype and business strategy need further adjustment and validation.

For the initial prototype, the first adjustment is to divide urgent tasks into more specific categories. Although this project defines tasks needed within one week as urgent tasks, the MVP tests and follow-up interviews suggest

that different urgent tasks create different expectations from both job posters and job seekers. Price, candidate skills, task duration, reliability, and convenience may vary depending on whether the task is a small private micro-task, a physical moving task, or a company-based urgent staffing need. Therefore, task type should be included in the matching and pricing logic, together with location, availability, candidate score, structured job post information, and price.

The second adjustment is to further develop the matching algorithm. Instead of relying mainly on GPS-based matching, the platform should combine distance, availability, response completeness, task-relevant experience, trust score, task fit, and job poster preferences. Price can be included as a supporting factor, but it should not be treated as the only driver of successful matching.

For the business strategy, further research is needed to evaluate whether the project has enough resources and market potential to continue. The two strongest value propositions of FlexMatch require a relatively large user base. First, the platform aims to create quick matching between job posters and job seekers. Second, for companies, the platform aims to reduce administrative work by supporting contract, payroll, payment, and possibly insurance handling. Both functions may create strong value, but they also require trust, sufficient platform activity, operational capacity, and initial investment. Therefore, more validation is needed before fully committing to the startup project.

In the next iteration, the MVP should test a more realistic pre-designed app or website prototype that simulates structured task posting, task categorization, candidate ranking, shortlist recommendations, platform-based communication, trust indicators, and a more detailed pricing algorithm for different urgent task groups. In addition, further tests should be conducted on marketing channels, competitive positioning, user acquisition, and the feasibility of payroll, contract, payment, and insurance handling.

Overall, the current decision is to continue with an adjusted prototype but not yet make a final decision to fully persevere. The next stage should focus on testing whether FlexMatch can build enough user activity, operational trust, and commercial feasibility to support a sustainable business model.

1E. Business Opportunity and Business Model Canvas

Based on the entire process of trend analysis, validation interviews, fake door experiment, and MVP cycles the project has identified a clear and commercially viable business opportunity a, location based shorter term task matching platform targeting the Danish market. For both the work seekers and work takers.

The Opportunity

Both demand and supply for flexible short-term work are growing yet there is no one connecting the two sides. Individuals need urgent help for tasks such as moving, pet care, cleaning, or event support, and small businesses regularly face unexpected staffing gaps. On the other side, students and freelancers have the time and want to earn flexible income but cannot reliably find relevant short-term opportunities.

Existing solutions such as Facebook job groups, staffing agencies, and traditional platforms have been shown through this project's research to be inefficient, slow, and poorly designed for this type of urgent, informal matching. Our experiments revealed that admin approval delays, fragmented communication, and the dominance of company/agency posts make these channels unsuitable for private micro-tasks. There is no dedicated platform in the Danish market that solves this problem end-to-end.

The proposed platform fills this gap by offering GPS-enabled, structured tasks matching between job posters and available workers with built-in trust mechanisms, payroll handling, and a commission-based revenue model. The MVP experiments confirmed that the core product logic is sound: structured posts improve match quality, location proximity drives response speed, and job posters are willing to pay a commission if the service saves time and delivers reliability.

How It Addresses the Identified Need

The platform directly addresses the three core problems identified during the project:

- Demand-side friction: Job posters can post a task in under a minute, receive structured applications, and get a match within hours without managing scattered messages or admin delays.
- Supply side instability: Job seekers can find relevant, nearby, and immediately available tasks rather than competing for formal positions or relying on opaque agency pipelines.
- System-level inefficiency: The platform's matching algorithm informed directly by MVP findings prioritises location, availability, task-fit, and trust signals, eliminating the coordination friction that makes existing channels unreliable.

Value Proposition and Profitability

The platform's core value proposition differs for each side of the market. For job posters, the platform offers speed, reliability, and reduced administrative burden including optional handling of temporary contracts and salary payments, a feature strongly validated through business interviews where administrative complexity was

identified as a major pain point alongside the staffing shortage itself. For job seekers, the platform offers flexibility, transparency, and guaranteed payment without navigating unresponsive agencies or irrelevant job postings.

The revenue model is commission-based. Job posters pay a 5–10% service fee on ordinary tasks, rising to approximately 15% for urgent or premium matching. This pricing was validated through the fake door experiment and follow-up interviews, where job posters confirmed willingness to pay if the platform demonstrably saves time and improves reliability. For businesses requiring payroll and contract management, an additional administration fee creates a secondary revenue stream. The pricing logic is dynamic, adjusting based on urgency, task duration, task complexity, and whether the poster is a private individual or a company reflecting the nuanced findings from MVP 3.

The platform is designed to scale through network effects: as more workers join, response times improve, which attracts more job posters, which in turn attracts more workers. Early growth will be driven through university partnerships and targeted social media advertising channels already tested through the fake door QR code campaign deployed across two Danish university campuses.

The full Business Model Canvas. A summary of the nine building blocks is outlined below.

Key Partners	Key Activities	Value Propositions	Customer Relationships	Customer Segments
• Payment providers • Universities & student networks • Local communities • Legal/contract partners	• Real-time matching • Platform development • User acquisition • Trust & safety • Payroll administration	• Fast matching (hours) • Payroll & contract handling • Reliable versus the Facebook post • Flexible income • Location-based tasks	• Rating & review system • Third-party contracts • Automated onboarding • Low-friction communication	• Individuals with urgent needs • Small businesses • Students & freelancers
Key Resources		Channels		
• Platform & app • GPS matching algorithm • Trust/rating system • Two-sided user base		• Mobile app • Landing page • Facebook groups (early) • Social media ads • University outreach		

Key Partners	Key Activities	Value Propositions	Customer Relationships	Customer Segments
Cost Structure		Revenue Streams		
Platform development & maintenance Marketing & user acquisition Early-stage manual matching operations Legal & contract support Customer support		Commission per task: 5–10% (standard), up to 15% (urgent) Payroll administration fee (businesses) Optional: premium/priority matching fee		

Table 4– Business Canvas Overview

2A. Reflection on uncertainty

Uncertainty is an essential element of the entrepreneurial process. While developing the FlexMatch platform, our team continuously worked to understand and reduce the unknown variables that characterized our idea. In order to structure our reflection on how we managed this process, we rely on the theoretical framework from the course literature, which categorizes uncertainty into four distinct types, absolute uncertainty, creative uncertainty, risk and ambiguity, and environmental uncertainty (Packard et al., 2017). By applying these concepts along with theories of entrepreneurial decision making, it becomes prominent how our project evolved and how we balanced opposing management paradoxes.

At the very beginning of the project, we faced Absolute uncertainty. We had an idea for a quick job and task matching platform, but it was highly uncertain whether this represented a real market opportunity or just an interesting thought. In this early phase, we experienced the paradox between discovery and creation. The discovery perspective suggests that opportunities exist objectively in the market as profit gaps waiting to be noticed by alert individuals (Kirzner, 1979). Our initial trend analysis supported this perspective, as the data showed a clear growth in flexible work and the gig economy. However, trend data alone could not confirm whether people in our specific local context actually needed this exact platform.

Because the objective data was insufficient, we had to adopt the creation perspective. This perspective argues that opportunities do not exist independently of human action, rather, they are created and emerge through interaction (Fletcher, 2003). To move past our Absolute uncertainty, we designed a fake door experiment. We

did not know if a two sided market of job posters and job seekers actually existed. The fake door test allowed us to fabricate a situation where users could interact with our concept. With both sides expressing clear interest, this experiment reduced our Absolute uncertainty and provided the confidence needed to proceed.

As we gathered more qualitative data through interviews, we encountered Creative uncertainty. This type of uncertainty happens when a goal is identified, but the specific solutions remain completely open. To begin with, our problem was formulated as a simple observation that businesses need short term workers. However, our interviews with job posters and job seekers revealed a much more complex reality. Job posters explained that their main problem was not just a lack of available workers, but they also faced deep uncertainty around worker reliability, the time required for onboarding, task fit and overall trust. Similarly, job seeker interviews showed that they would not blindly accept micro tasks. They showed interest only when tasks were transparent, trustworthy, located nearby and fully compatible with their unpredictable schedules.

This new information forced us to rethink our entire approach. Using the reframing theories from Bianchi and Verganti (2021), we engaged in problem expansion and problem elevation. The original problem changed from a simple staffing shortage to a broader issue of trust, coordination, speed and the availability of flexible labor. This reframing was necessary, but it also highlighted the evaluation paradox between instrumental logic and legitimacy. On one hand, we used instrumental evaluation by looking at measurable data, such as the high conversion rate from our fake door test. On the other hand, we realized that rational numbers were not enough. We needed real user acceptance based on social legitimacy. The interviews proved that building trust and transparent communication were required to gain this legitimacy among users.

Having reframed the problem, we still faced uncertainty regarding our prototype design. We did not know which platform functions mattered most to our users. Was the solution fast matching, GPS tracking, structured communication, trust signals or handling payments and contracts? To test these variables, we transitioned from Creative uncertainty to Risk and ambiguity, where specific options could be tested against measurable outcomes. We did this by applying the Lean Startup methodology. Blank (2013) defines a startup as a temporary organization designed to search for a repeatable and scalable business model, instead of relying on traditional business planning, we used the Build Measure Learn cycle to test our assumptions directly in the market.

This approach helped us manage the paradox between planning and improvisation. While a business plan can structure a project, using it too early can curb creativity and limit learning. Our project followed the planned Lean Startup process first, allowing us to improvise and change the prototype based on new findings, and we saved

the formal business model development for later. We built three Minimum Viable Products to test our specific hypotheses.

The first test, MVP 1, was designed to test whether existing Facebook groups could already solve the problem. We manually matched users in these groups. The experiment proved that existing channels were highly inefficient. MVP 1 showed severe delays, fragmented communication across different messages, privacy barriers, and weak filtering.

The second test, MVP 2, tested whether a structured matching process would improve candidate selection. We collected comparable applicant information and recommended candidates to the job poster. It was uncertain if this would work better than simple GPS matching. MVP 2 showed that location is important, but availability, past experience, response completeness and trust signals must be included to create a successful match.

The third test, MVP 3, focused on price sensitivity. It was uncertain whether offering higher pay would automatically create better matches. We tested the same task at three different hourly rates. MVP 3 showed that while higher pay increased the number of responses and the speed of replies, it did not automatically improve the quality of the applicants. Through these Lean Startup experiments, we were able to measure user behavior and learn exactly what functions our prototype needed.

As the project matured and the prototype became more defined, our focus shifted toward the business model. It was highly uncertain whether the platform could be profitable. Here, we faced the paradox between explore and exploit. The early stages of our project were dedicated entirely to exploring the opportunity space through qualitative research and manual low cost experiments. However, the data from the fake door experiment and MVP 3 showed a potential commission logic. This forced us to start considering how to exploit the opportunity through a viable business model, scaling strategy and commission structure.

In defining this business model, we also experienced the rational versus embedded paradox. We used rational decision making tools, such as setting hypotheses, tracking conversion metrics and calculating pricing averages. Yet, our tests and the resulting business model were deeply embedded in the specific local contexts of the Danish market. The behaviors of our users were heavily influenced by their prior experiences in Danish Facebook groups, their geographical locations and their cultural expectations regarding trust and communication.

Looking at our entire entrepreneurial process, we can see a clear shift in our decision making logic from effectuation to causation. In the beginning, we operated under high uncertainty and used effectuation. We started with the resources we had available, namely our networks and local Facebook groups. We followed the

affordable loss principle by running low cost manual tests rather than investing heavily in a digital platform. We embraced surprises and adapted our understanding of the problem as we went along. Gradually, as the problem and the opportunity became clearer, our approach became more causal. We began to set more specific goals, used structured metrics to test hypotheses, and focused on the future profitability of the business model.

Entrepreneurial judgment is an ongoing process of reassessment and learning. Even after extensive testing, our project still did not have a final definitive answer. The final decision was to continue with an adjusted prototype and conduct further tests before fully persevering. This decision reflects the ongoing presence of Environmental uncertainty. The exact reactions of competitors, the full feasibility of administrative functions like payroll handling and the ultimate proof of profitability remain unknown. By acknowledging this uncertainty, we continue to use data and iterative testing to guide our future actions rather than relying on groundless predictions.

2B. Entrepreneurial decision-making logics

Throughout our startup, our entrepreneurial decision-making logic contained a combination of effectuation, causation and lean startup logic, with effectuation being the main approach in the early stages of the startup, whereas causation became more influential later.

Initially, our startup follows the effectuation approach, because we didn't start with a fully predefined business model or final solution. Instead, we began with the resources and knowledge already available to us, including access to our fellow students, local business, Facebook groups and our understanding/experience within the job market. Through interviews, observational research and fake-door experiments, our understanding on how we generated value evolved over time, rather than predicting the outcome, we chose to let our research guide us throughout the process and adapt as new information was collected along the journey.

The effectuation effect is also shown in how the project framed the original problem, where at first we focused on short-term staffing shortages, but after conducting interviews and validating research, we learned that the deeper issue was more about trust, coordination and operational integration in the labor market.

In addition, the startup also reflected the principle of affordable loss, which is central within effectuation theory. Instead of investing significant time into building a functional test platform immediately, we conducted low-cost MVP experiments through Facebook groups, manual matching processes, and fake-door testing. These experiments allowed us to validate assumptions and gather behavioral data while minimizing time waste and uncertainty.

Throughout the journey the element of causation logic became increasingly more important, during later stages of the startup. Once the main problem was defined, the process also became clearer, and there it was easier to create a more structured and goal-oriented plan. The assumptions were transformed into hypotheses and tested through MVPs via the lean startup method.

Going forward causation would be the main entrepreneurial decision-making logic, where the focus would be more goal-driven, structured and contain better strategic planning. And working towards limiting uncertainty, which made the effectuation logic effective in the beginning. The startup now has a clearer vision regarding how we generate value, which would allow us to enter the next phase.

The future development of the platform will become more goal driven. The startup now has a clearer long-term objective, creating a scalable platform capable of delivering fast, trustworthy, and structured short-term labor matching. Future versions would also focus on specific strategic goals such as developing a functional app prototype, creating the matching algorithm, increasing userbase, and building partnerships. Instead of mainly exploring new possibilities, the next stage would include a clear roadmap toward market launch and growth.

Future decision-making will place stronger emphasis on expected returns. While the early MVP experiments focused on learning and validation, the startup can now evaluate decisions based on profitability and scalability. The experiments already demonstrated that job posters are willing to pay commissions and urgency fees for faster and more reliable matching services. This provides a foundation for forecasting future revenue streams, customer acquisition costs, and long-term business sustainability. As the platform develops further, investment decisions, pricing models, and platform features will be assessed based on their expected financial and strategic returns.

The project will also require a more comprehensive competitive analysis going forward. During the early phase, the focus was primarily on identifying user problems and validating whether the opportunity existed. However, as the concept becomes more concrete, it becomes increasingly more important to analyze competitors such as Facebook job groups, staffing agencies, gig platforms, and other labor marketplaces. Understanding competitor's weaknesses, market positioning, and customer frustrations will help strengthen our startup's strategy. The startup has already identified that existing solutions suffer from delays and inconsistent communication, which creates a competitive advantage for a more structured and trust-based platform.

Finally, the future process will also increasingly attempt to limit contingencies and reduce uncertainty through planning, structure, and operational systems.

In the earlier stages, contingencies and uncertainty were actively sought out, as part of the learning process. However, as the business model became clearer, the focus shifts toward reducing unpredictability through standardized processes, automated matching systems, trust mechanisms, and platform governance. Future development will therefore likely involve more formal planning regarding scaling, legal requirements, payroll handling, customer support, and operational reliability. In this sense, the project gradually transitions from entrepreneurial exploration toward strategic execution and organizational control.

Overall, the project shows a gradual movement from effectual exploration toward more causal and structured decision-making. In the early stage, effectuation helped the team explore the opportunity with limited resources and adapt the problem understanding through interviews, observational research, and fake-door testing. Later, as the problem and opportunity became clearer, causation became more relevant because the project needed more structured goals, clearer hypotheses, and a stronger basis for evaluating future business potential. This transition provides the basis for explaining how these decision-making logics shaped the project structure, MVP development, and hypothesis testing.

Decision-making logic influences our project

The hybrid use of effectuation, causation, and Lean Startup logic directly influenced how the project was structured. At the beginning, the project had a general goal of exploring a platform for quick job and task matching, but the exact problem, target users, and value proposition were still uncertain. Therefore, the project was first structured around exploration. Trend analysis, interviews, observational research, and fake-door testing were used to understand whether there was a real need for urgent staffing support, flexible work, and extra earning opportunities.

After the problem was reframed, the process became more structured through the Lean Startup approach. The prototype was not treated as a final solution, but as a set of assumptions that needed to be tested. These assumptions were then translated into measurable hypotheses, such as whether existing Facebook-based channels created delays, whether structured communication improved candidate filtering, whether location influenced response behavior, and whether job posters were willing to pay for faster and more reliable matching. In this way, causation helped the team organize the testing process, while effectuation kept the project flexible enough to adapt when new findings appeared. This approach is also supported by Camuffo et al. (2020), who argue that entrepreneurial decision-making can become more evidence-based when assumptions are translated into clear hypotheses and tested before committing to a business direction. In our project, this was reflected in

the way the prototype assumptions were not accepted as true from the beginning, but were tested through behavioral evidence such as delays visibility, response time, applicant quality, and willingness to pay.

The same logic also shaped the MVP development. Instead of investing in a complete digital platform immediately, the team developed low-cost MVPs using accessible resources. MVP 1 used Facebook groups and manual matching to test the friction in existing informal channels. MVP 2 used a structured task post and third-party filtering to test whether candidate comparison and trust could be improved. MVP 3 tested different hourly prices to understand how payment influenced applicant quantity, response speed, and applicant quality. These MVPs were therefore not mini versions of the final platform, but practical experiments designed to test the most critical assumptions behind the business idea. This also aligns with Paust, Korsgaard and Thrane's (2025) view of entrepreneurial prototyping, where prototypes are used not only to present an idea, but also to experiment, learn, and adjust the venture with available resources. (Paust et al., 2025) In this project, the MVPs helped us avoid premature investment in a full platform, while still generating useful learning about matching friction, trust, structure, location, and pricing.

The way the hypotheses were tested also reflected this hybrid logic. On one hand, the team used measurable indicators such as visibility delay, response time, applicant location, applicant usability, willingness to pay, and commission acceptance. This made the process more causal and evidence based. On the other hand, the team remained open to unexpected learning. For example, the tests showed that fast matching alone was not enough. Matching quality also depended on structure, trust, availability, task type, location, and price. This reflects the effectual logic of using unexpected findings as inputs for further development rather than treating them as failures.

As a result, the project moved from a simple idea of a fast GPS-based job matching platform toward a more refined concept: a structured, trust-based, location-sensitive, and price-aware platform for urgent tasks. This also explains why the project has not yet made a final decision to fully persevere. The current decision is to continue with an adjusted prototype and conduct further tests on task categorization, pricing logic, marketing channels, user acquisition, competitive positioning, and the feasibility of payroll, contract, payment, and insurance handling. In this sense, the project used effectuation to explore under uncertainty, Lean Startup to test assumptions through MVPs, and causation to structure the next stage of strategic development (Sarasvathy, 2001; Blank, 2013). This also reflects the decision-making paradox between planning and improvisation: the team used structured hypotheses and measurable indicators but still had to adapt the prototype when the findings showed that fast GPS-based matching alone was not sufficient (Nielsen et al., 2012).

2C. Reflection on Team Process

The FlexMatch project was developed by a group of four with different personality profiles and skills that supplemented each other. Reflecting on the team dynamics throughout the project shows how individual traits shaped the groups process, and how the team collectively navigated decision-making in uncertainty. It even showed up in the beginning with different ideas going on for the first months before we ended up deciding on this project.

Team composition and personality diversity

The 16 Personalities test results reveal a team with notable diversity in thinking and interpersonal styles. Ruyi tested as ESFJ-A (Consul), characterised by strong practical skills, a high sense of duty, loyalty, and an extroverted orientation toward social coordination. Tancredi and Rasmus both tested as INFP-T (Mediator), sharing traits of introversion, intuitive thinking, emotional sensitivity, and a, suggesting openness to exploration and resistance to rigid structure. Mikkel tested as ENTP-A (Debater), an Analyst type characterised by extroversion, intuitive and rational thinking, intellectual flexibility, and tending to challenge existing systems and assumptions.

This diversity shows what this course literature describes as the functional heterogeneity of entrepreneurial teams. As Vyakarnam and Handelberg (2005) points out a team's performance in new ventures is shaped not only by demographic variables but also process variables, including how individual members integrate into task execution. The presence of a structurally oriented profile (Ruyi/ESFJ), two empathic and exploratory profiles (Tancredi and Rasmus/INFP), and a rationally challenging profile (Mikkel/ENTP) meant the team covered a broad functional spectrum: operational coordination, creative ideation, and critical analytical thinking of ideas.

Contributions to the entrepreneurial process

In practice, this personality mix manifested across different phases of the project. During the trend identification and problem framing stages, the intuitive and feeling-oriented members were well-suited to the qualitative, exploratory nature of the work, conducting interviews, interpreting behavioural patterns, and generating ideas for the prototype. The structured and observant qualities associated with the ESFJ profile contributed particularly to the coordination of the MVP experiments, the data collection process, and ensuring that tasks were completed reliably and on time.

Cooney (2005) challenges the myth of the lone entrepreneur and argues that successful ventures typically benefit from multiple founders who bid in with complementary financial, experiential, and emotional resources and

skillsets. The FlexMatch team reflects this logic no single member possessed all competencies required to move from trend identification through MVP testing to business model development. Instead, the team functioned as what Cooney (2005) terms an entrepreneurial team a group of individuals who actively and jointly participated in the development of the enterprise across its key stages.

Decision-making under uncertainty

Navigating uncertainty was a recurring challenge, particularly in the MVP phase where the team had to make decisions based on limited and sometimes unclear data. The INFP personalities' tendency toward prospecting remaining open and adaptive rather than closing options prematurely proved useful in iterative experimentation. However, it also created risk of indecision, which the ESFJ team member's judging and organisational traits helped counterbalance by pushing toward structured conclusions and measurable outcomes.

A particular tension arose around the pricing experiments in MVP 3, where the data was not fully conclusive and required interpretation. Rather than each member independently drawing separate conclusions, the team converged through discussion, aligning on the commission-based model supported by the broader fake-door data. This reflects what Vyakarnam and Handelberg (2005) describe as the importance of personal integration into the task process. The extent to which individual members actively engage with and shape collective decisions rather than deferring or withdrawing.

Team cohesion and productive conflict

Beyond personality dynamics, the team's ability to maintain cohesion while navigating disagreement was central to the project's progression. Ensley, Pearson and Amason (2002) distinguish between affective conflict interpersonal tension that undermines collaboration — and cognitive conflict — task-focused disagreement that can improve decision quality in new ventures. Their research demonstrates that entrepreneurial teams with high cognitive conflict and high affective cohesion tend to outperform teams that avoid conflict altogether, as constructive challenge forces more rigorous evaluation of assumptions.

This distinction was relevant to the FlexMatch process. During the MVP 3 pricing analysis, team members held differing interpretations of what the data implied for the commission structure. Rather than suppressing this disagreement, the team used the structured data from the fake-door experiment as a shared reference point, which shifted the discussion from interpersonal opinion to evidence-based evaluation. This is consistent with

Ensley et al.'s (2002) finding that teams which institutionalise objective criteria for decision-making are better equipped to convert cognitive conflict into actionable outcomes without it escalating into affective conflict.

Collaboration and adaptation

One observable challenge related to the INFP profiles' known sensitivity to criticism and discomfort with conflict. In entrepreneurial settings, this can slow down difficult decisions or lead to consensus-seeking at the expense of critical evaluation. The team addressed this partly by grounding disagreements in data rather than opinion a natural fit with the quantitative MVP structure which reduced the group friction that might otherwise might have come from a more subjective debate.

The ESFJ profile's known weakness around inflexibility and reluctance to improvise also required adaptation. In a Lean Startup process that inherently demands iteration and willingness to pivot, the team had to consciously hold open the possibility of fundamental changes to the prototype. The decision to persevere with an adjusted prototype, rather than pivot or perish, reflects a negotiated balance between the ESFJ inclination toward stability and the INFP inclination toward openness.

The role of the individual within the team

Despite the collective nature of the process, individual agency remained significant. Shaver and Scott (1991), as cited in Cooney (2005), argue that even within team entrepreneurship, a single person is often needed in whose mind the possibilities come together and who maintains the motivation to persist. Throughout the FlexMatch project, this manifested not as a fixed lead entrepreneur but as a rotating responsibility different members taking initiative at different stages depending on their strengths which is consistent with Cooney's (2005) view of entrepreneurial teams as fluid and evolutionary rather than static.

Overall, the team's personality diversity proved to be an advantage. The complementarity skills between structured execution and creative exploration, when channeled through the iterative structure of the Lean Startup methodology, enabled the team to produce validated insights that no individual member could have done alone.

List of References

- Berglund, H. (2021). Entrepreneurship as design and design science. *Journal of Business Venturing Design*, 1(1–2), Article 100012. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbvd.2022.100012>
- Bianchi, M., & Verganti, R. (2021). Entrepreneurs as designers of problems worth solving. *Journal of Business Venturing Design*, 1(1–2), Article 100006. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbvd.2022.100006>
- Blank, S. (2013). *Why the lean start-up changes everything*. *Harvard Business Review*, 91(5), 63–72.
- Camuffo, A., Cordova, A., Gambardella, A., & Spina, C. (2020). A scientific approach to entrepreneurial decision making: Evidence from a randomized control trial. *Management Science*, 66(2), 564–586. <https://doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.2018.3249>
- Cooney, T. M. (2005). What is an entrepreneurial team? *International Small Business Journal*, 23(3), 226–235. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0266242605052131>
- Ensley, M. D., Pearson, A. W., & Amason, A. C. (2002). Understanding the dynamics of new venture top management teams: Cohesion, conflict, and new venture performance. *Journal of Business Venturing*, 17(4), 365–386. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0883-9026\(00\)00065-3](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0883-9026(00)00065-3)
- Kirzner, I. M. (1973). *Competition and entrepreneurship*. University of Chicago Press.
- McKinsey & Company. (2023, August 2). What is the gig economy? <https://www.mckinsey.com/featured-insights/mckinsey-explainers/what-is-the-gig-economy>
- Nielsen, M. S. (2026, April 29). *The role of the individual: Lecture 10 [PowerPoint slides]*. University of Southern Denmark.
- Nielsen, S. L., Klyver, K., Evald, M. R., & Bager, T. (2012). *Entrepreneurship in theory and practice: Paradoxes in play*. Edward Elgar Publishing.
- Packard, M. D., Clark, B. B., & Klein, P. G. (2017). Uncertainty types and transitions in the entrepreneurial process. *Organization Science*, 28(5), 840–856. <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2017.1143>
- Paust, S., Korsgaard, S., & Thrane, C. (2025). Entrepreneurial prototyping: The role of purpose, prototype recycling, and skills bricolage. *Small Business Economics*, 64, 407–431. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11187-024-00922-2>

Sarasvathy, S. D. (2001). *Causation and effectuation: Toward a theoretical shift from economic inevitability to entrepreneurial contingency*. *Academy of Management Review*, 26(2), 243–263.

<https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2001.4378020>

Schor, J. B., Attwood-Charles, W., Cansoy, M., Ladegaard, I., & Wengronowitz, R. (2020). *Dependence and precarity in the platform economy*. *Theory and Society*, 49(5–6), 833–861. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11186-020-09408-y>

University of Bristol. (2023). *Gig rights & gig wrongs: Initial findings from the Gig Rights Project*. University of Bristol. <https://www.bristol.ac.uk/media-library/sites/business-school/documents/Gig%20Rights%20%26%20Gig%20Wrongs%20Report.pdf>

Vyakarnam, S., & Handelberg, J. (2005). *Four themes of the impact of management teams on organizational performance: Implications for future research of entrepreneurial teams*. *International Small Business Journal*, 23(3), 236–256. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0266242605052072>

World Economic Forum. (2024, November 22). *What is the gig economy and what's the deal for gig workers?* <https://www.weforum.org/stories/2024/11/what-gig-economy-workers/>

List of Appendices

Appendix 1b-01. Job Poster Interview Summary

*AI is used to create summaries from interviews.

File: Job posters Interview.docx

Purpose

The purpose of the job poster interviews was to validate the demand-side problem: whether businesses experience urgent or short-term staffing needs, how they currently handle these situations, and what prevents them from using external workers more effectively.

Research design

The study used a qualitative semi-structured interview approach. This allowed the team to ask the same core questions across participants while still leaving space for follow-up questions and deeper explanations. The interviews focused on urgent staffing needs, strategies for managing shortages, perceptions of external workers, and the operational impact of staffing problems.

Participants

Participant type	Industry context	Relevance to project
DJ company owner	Event services	Experiences last-minute bookings and cancellations
Store manager	Retail	Experiences demand fluctuations during openings, promotions, and busy periods
Restaurant owner	Food service	Experiences sudden staff shortages during rush hours

Key findings

Theme	Summary of finding	Relevance to FlexMatch
Demand unpredictability	All participants described demand as difficult to predict. Last-minute bookings, unexpected busy periods, and staff sickness created urgent staffing gaps.	Supports the need for a platform that can respond quickly to urgent staffing needs.

Theme	Summary of finding	Relevance to FlexMatch
Availability is not enough	Businesses did not only need “someone available.” They needed people who were reliable, suitable, and able to fit existing routines.	Supports the need for trust indicators, task fit, ratings, and structured applicant information.
Time pressure limits external help	Even when external workers were available, participants often lacked time to onboard or supervise them during urgent situations.	Supports the platform’s focus on pre-filtered candidates and reduced coordination effort.
Internal coping is common	Businesses often solved shortages internally by redistributing tasks, working more themselves, or accepting lower efficiency.	Shows that current solutions are not fully trusted or convenient enough.
Operational and emotional impact	Staffing shortages affected customer waiting time, employee stress, service quality, and reputation.	Supports the value proposition of reducing operational stress and improving reliability.
Conditional openness to external solutions	Participants were open to better external solutions, but only if reliability, quality, and low onboarding needs could be proven.	Supports the need for MVP testing, trust mechanisms, and structured matching.

Important supporting points

The interviews showed that short-term staffing problems are not only caused by a lack of available workers. The deeper issue is that businesses need workers who can be trusted, integrated quickly, and matched to the task with minimal supervision. This matches the final report’s reframed problem: urgent work matching is not only about labour access, but also about **trust, coordination, reliability, and operational fit**.

Appendix 1b-02: Job Seeker Interview Summary

*AI is used to create summaries from interviews.

File: Job seeker interview.docx

Purpose

The purpose of the job seeker interview was to validate the supply-side problem: whether individuals are interested in short, flexible micro-jobs, whether they have unused time they want to monetize, and what factors influence their willingness to accept short-term tasks.

Research design

The interview used open-ended and non-leading questions focused on past behaviour, motivations, preferences, frustrations, and response time expectations. The questions were divided into three areas: current behaviour and idle time, motivations and preferences, and frictions in finding short-term flexible work.

Participants

Participant type	Work experience / context	Relevance to project
Speaker 1	Experience with Fiverr and short contract-based work	Shows interest in flexible task-based work and importance of clarity/professionalism
Speaker 2	Experience with temporary work platforms in Denmark, including warehouse work	Shows financial motivation, issues with job transparency, delayed payment, and scheduling uncertainty

Key findings

Theme	Summary of finding	Relevance to FlexMatch
Interest in short-term work	Participants had searched for side jobs, temporary jobs, or short gigs through platforms such as Fiverr and Templi.	Supports the existence of supply-side interest in flexible micro-work.
Fragmented free time	Participants described free time during afternoons or weekends that they wanted to use more productively.	Supports the idea that students and individuals may use a platform to fill short time gaps.

Theme	Summary of finding	Relevance to FlexMatch
Financial motivation	Money was a key motivation, especially for immediate expenses such as rent.	Supports the assumption that small financial incentives can motivate participation.
Non-financial motivation	Participants also mentioned networking, cultural integration, productivity, and future career opportunities.	Shows that flexible work is not only about income, but also about personal and social value.
Transparency matters	Negative experiences were linked to unclear job expectations, unexpected manual labour, delayed payment, and poorer conditions than permanent workers.	Supports the need for clear task descriptions, payment information, and transparent conditions.
Trust is a key filter	Participants emphasized that they want to know who is behind the task and whether the employer or company seems authentic and trustworthy.	Supports trust indicators, ratings, verified posters, and platform-based communication.
Flexibility vs predictability	Participants wanted flexible work, but still needed notice before starting. One participant mentioned needing around 10–12 hours of notice.	Supports the need for task timing clarity and availability-based matching.
Task preference varies	Participants preferred lighter or social tasks such as flyer distribution, events, and admin work, while physical or unclear tasks were less attractive.	Supports the later recommendation that urgent tasks should be categorized more clearly.

Important supporting points

The interviews showed that job seekers are open to flexible short-term work, but they do not accept tasks based only on availability or payment. They also evaluate trust, safety, task clarity, location, convenience, and scheduling predictability. This matches the final report's conclusion that the platform should not only focus on fast matching, but also on **structure, trust, location, availability, task type, and price**.

Appendix 1b-03: Fake-Door Experiment Summary

*AI is used to create summaries from fake door data collection

File: FakeDoor_Data Collection.xlsx

File: Fakedoor_posters

Purpose

The fake-door experiment was conducted to validate whether there was real market interest in a flexible micro-job platform before developing a full digital product. The purpose was to test whether both sides of the market existed: job posters who need urgent or short-term help, and job seekers who want flexible earning opportunities.

Experiment Design

A fake-door landing page and QR-code campaign were used to collect behavioural signals from potential users. Instead of launching a real platform, users were invited to express interest by submitting their information as either job posters or job seekers. This allowed the team to test demand at low cost and reduce uncertainty before further prototype development.

Data Collection Overview

Measurement	Result
Campaign period	41 days
Paid advertising	No
Total page views	137
Total sessions	101
Total submissions	82
Page-view-to-submission conversion rate	81.2%
Job poster submissions	28
Job seeker submissions	54

Key Findings

Theme	Summary of Finding	Relevance to FlexMatch
Market interest	The experiment generated 82 submissions without paid advertising.	Supports the existence of interest in a flexible micro-job platform.
Two-sided market	Both job posters and job seekers submitted interest through the same campaign.	Supports the platform logic of connecting two user groups.
Supply-side strength	Job seekers made up 54 submissions, compared with 28 job posters.	Indicates that early platform development may have stronger worker-side interest.
Demand-side validation	28 job posters submitted task-related interest.	Supports the assumption that some users need short-term or urgent help.
Conversion strength	The page-view-to-submission conversion rate was 81.2%.	Suggests that the platform concept was clear enough to trigger user action.
Geographic interest	Larger cities such as Copenhagen and Aarhus showed browsing interest, while cities such as Kolding, Horsens, Fredericia, and Vejle showed stronger submission conversion.	Suggests that both urban interest and local operational demand may exist.

Pricing Signals

Price Field	Numeric Responses	Range	Average
Job poster: expected pay for task	23	50–300 DKK	190.0 DKK
Job poster: willingness to pay for instant matching	18	20–150 DKK	65.6 DKK
Job seeker: expected earning	43	50–200 DKK/hour	112.1 DKK/hour

Interpretation

The fake-door experiment provided early evidence that both sides of the market were interested in the platform concept. Job seekers showed clear willingness to participate in flexible micro-work, while job posters showed interest in paying for short-term task completion and faster matching. The pricing data also suggests that faster and more reliable matching may create additional value beyond the task payment itself.

However, the results should be interpreted as early validation rather than final proof of market viability. A fake-door test measures interest and intention, but it does not fully confirm repeated platform use, long-term willingness to pay, or operational feasibility.

Appendix 1d-01. Prototype illustrations and platform concept designs

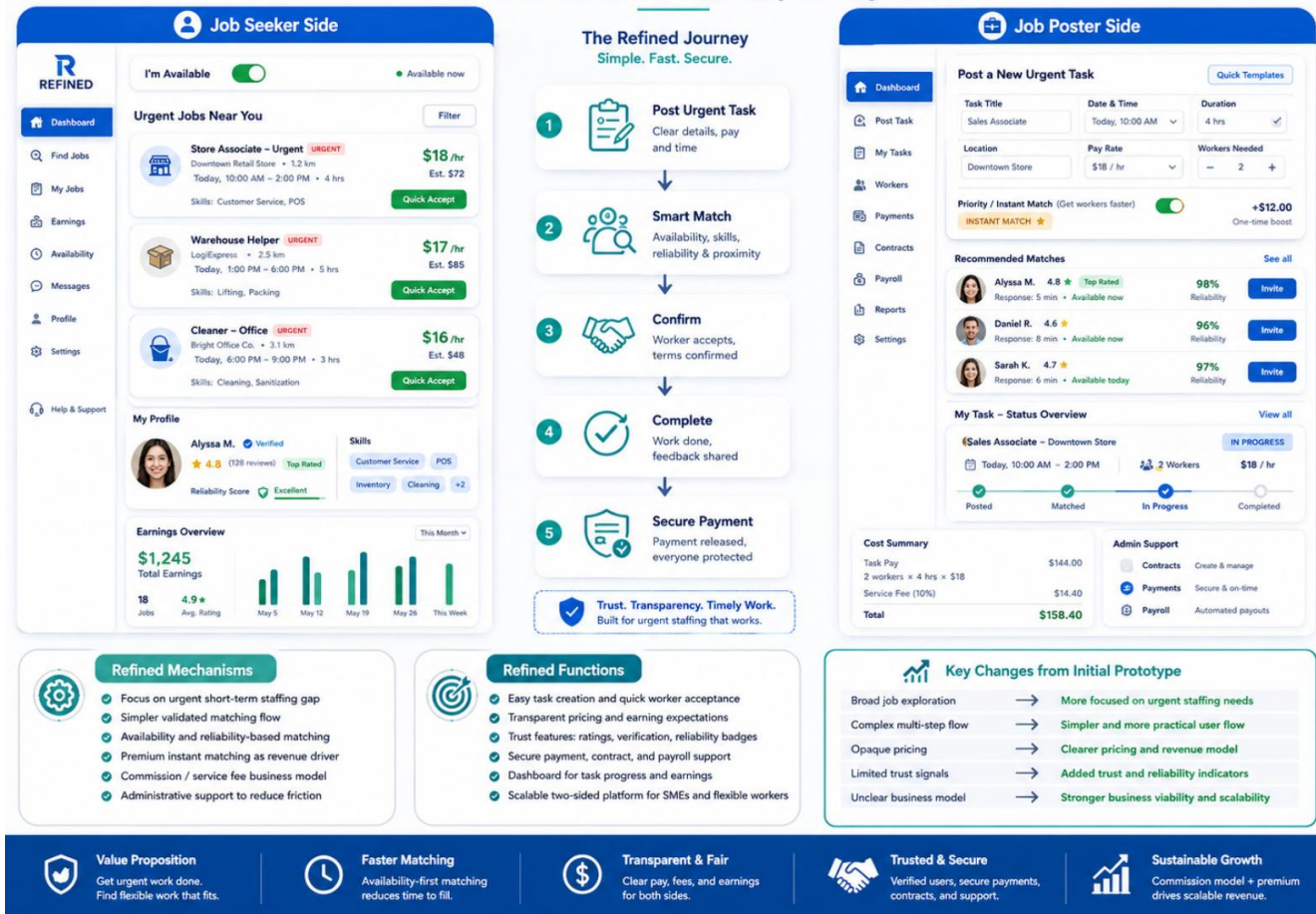
*AI is used to create Prototype pictures



Picture 1 - The initial prototype design

Platform After MVPs and Business Model Refinement

A more focused, validated, and scalable urgent staffing solution



Picture 2 - The adjusted prototype design

Appendix 1d-02. Assumptions vs. prototype mapping table

Prototype element	Related assumption	Why this assumption matters	Tested through
Fast and urgent matching	Existing channels such as Facebook groups create delays, fragmented communication, and weak candidate filtering.	The prototype promises faster matching, so it must solve the exact friction points that make current channels slow.	Observational research + MVP 1
GPS/location-based recommendations	Location and proximity influence response speed and applicant suitability.	The prototype depends on recommending nearby workers, so location must be tested as a meaningful matching variable.	MVP 1, MVP 2, MVP 3
Structured matching process	Structured applicant information makes candidate comparison and selection easier.	The prototype should not only display applicants, but help job posters compare and select suitable candidates quickly.	MVP 2
Centralized platform communication	Platform-based communication reduces fragmented communication, privacy concerns, and coordination friction.	The prototype aims to avoid scattered Facebook comments, private messages, and friend requests.	MVP 1 + MVP 2 follow-up interview
Trust-based matching	Trust signals, ratings, reliability indicators, and clearer task descriptions improve perceived candidate quality.	Urgent matching still requires confidence, especially when job posters do not know the worker personally.	MVP 2 + follow-up interviews
Pricing and incentive logic	Financial incentives affect job seeker response behaviour, and job posters may pay for faster and more reliable matching.	The prototype needs both participation from workers and a sustainable business model.	Fake door analysis + MVP 3
Payment, contract, and payroll support	Platform-managed payment, agreement, or payroll handling creates extra value and professionalism.	The prototype aims to reduce administrative burden, especially for small businesses using temporary help.	Job poster interviews + prototype feedback + MVP 2 follow-up
Matching algorithm as key value proposition	Effective matching requires combining multiple variables rather than relying only on location or price.	The prototype's future value depends on ranking the most suitable candidates, not just showing all available workers.	MVP 1, MVP 2, MVP 3

Appendix 1d-03. Summary of MVP Learnings and Prototype Adjustments

Prototype mechanism	Evidence from MVPs	Prototype adjustment
Fast urgent matching	MVP 1 showed visibility delays and slow response problems.	Add instant posting and reduce admin-approval dependency.
Centralized communication	MVP 1 showed fragmented comments, messages, and friend requests; MVP 2 tested third-party filtering.	Add platform-based communication and avoid personal social-media contact.
Location-based matching	MVP 1–3 showed nearby applicants were more relevant for urgent tasks.	Keep location and distance as core ranking variables.
Structured matching	MVP 2 showed that comparable applicant information improved filtering.	Add structured application fields, candidate comparison, and automatic ranking.
Trust-based matching	MVP 2 follow-up interview emphasized reliability, ratings, and task fit.	Add trust score, reviews, reliability indicators, and response completeness.
Pricing logic	MVP 3 and fake-door data showed price affects response but not match quality alone.	Add pricing recommendation based on urgency, duration, location, and task difficulty.
Business model	Fake door and MVP 3 interviews showed willingness to pay/commission acceptance.	Test commission, urgency fee, or fixed service fee depending on task type.
Payment/agreement support	Interviews suggested payment/agreement handling increases professionalism.	Keep as future function, but do not claim it was fully MVP-tested.

Appendix 1d-04. MVP data collection sheets, post views, and follow-up interview transcripts

*AI is used to create summary from MVP data collections and transcribed follow up interviews.

*Detailed data and transcribe are in the additional attachments

MVP 1 :

File: MVP1_data collection

Experiment setup:

A cat-sitting task in Horsens was posted in four Facebook groups. The task required someone for 2 hours, paid 50 DKK, and was originally needed around 15:00. The team manually posted the task, observed visibility delay, collected responses, filtered applicants, and communicated with the job requester.

Key data and results:

Measurement	Result
Total applicants / contacts	7
Applicants from Horsens group	4
Share from Horsens group	57.1%
Average visibility delay	565.7 minutes
Median response after post became visible	130 minutes
Average response time after posting	1,058.1 minutes
Distinct contact channels	4
Average application completeness	3.57 / 5
Selected / shortlisted applicants	2
Groups requiring admin approval	3 of 4 groups

File: MVP1_follow up interview transcription

Purpose:

The follow-up interview was conducted with the job request person after MVP 1 to understand whether third-party coordination helped, whether the process was fast enough, and what should be improved in a future

platform. The task was a cat-sitting task in Horsens for two hours, posted in four Facebook groups. Seven people contacted the team, but the match could not be completed within the original required time window.

Key insights:

Theme	Summary
Third-party coordination	The job requester found it helpful that someone else handled posting and communication.
Speed	The process worked eventually, but it was not fast enough for the original urgent need.
Filtering difficulty	Applicant information was incomplete, especially around location, availability, and pet experience.
Trust	The requester wanted confirmed availability, location, pet experience, and future ratings/reviews.
Communication	Facebook communication was messy because applicants used comments, private messages, and friend requests.
Willingness to pay	The requester would pay a small fee for faster and more reliable urgent matching.
Platform improvement	The future platform should show nearby available people, collect communication in one place, and avoid using personal Facebook profiles.

MVP 2:

File: MVP2_data collection.xlsx

Experiment

setup:

A moving-helper task was posted in a Fredericia Facebook group without admin approval. The pay was 120 DKK/hour, and the task required help with boxes and furniture from 19:00. Applicants were asked to provide location, availability, relevant experience, and a short introduction.

Key data and results:

Measurement	Result
Total applicants	9
Applicants from Fredericia / nearby within 6 km	6
Average response time after visible	100.7 minutes
First response after visible	18 minutes
Complete applications, score ≥ 4	6
High-trust candidates, score ≥ 4	5
Recommended candidates	4
Selected candidates	2
Private message / friend-request contacts	7
Responses outside one clear platform channel	9

Matching logic tested:

The MVP used a simple scoring model based on availability, distance, moving/physical experience, application completeness, and trust score. The strongest candidate scored 98.3 and was selected because they were nearby, available, had strong moving experience, and gave a complete response.

File: MVP2_follow up interview transcription.docx

Purpose:

The interview was conducted after MVP 2 to understand how the job poster experienced the third-party matching process. The team acted as an intermediary by posting the task, collecting applicant information, filtering candidates, and recommending a match.

Key insights:

Theme	Summary
Reduced coordination effort	The job poster said it was helpful because they did not need to manage all messages or compare applicants manually.
Important matching criteria	Availability was most important, followed by location, reliability, relevant experience, and physical ability.
Candidate recommendation	The job poster felt the recommendation was mostly based on the right criteria.
Platform preference	The job poster preferred third-party/platform matching for small urgent tasks.
Communication need	Direct communication can be limited if time, place, payment, and task expectations are clearly confirmed.
Payment/agreement handling	Platform-managed payment and agreement handling would make the process feel more professional and secure.
Willingness to pay	The job poster would pay a small extra fee if the service saves time and provides a reliable person, especially for urgent tasks.

MVP 3:

file: MVP3_data collection

Experiment setup:

The same moving-helper task was tested at three different hourly pay levels: 50 DKK/hour, 120 DKK/hour, and 200 DKK/hour. The task content, location, and requirements were kept similar so that price sensitivity could be compared.

Key MVP 3 results:

Price level	Hourly pay	Total applicants	Usable applicants	Selected/backups	Avg. response time	Avg. completeness	Avg. trust score	Usable rate
Low price	50 DKK/hour	6	1	1	176.2 min	3.17	3.17	16.7%
Middle price	120 DKK/hour	9	4	2	104.7 min	3.78	3.56	44.4%
High price	200 DKK/hour	11	4	2	76.8 min	3.82	3.64	36.4%

Location results:

Price level	Local applicants	Total applicants	Local share	Local usable applicants
50 DKK/hour	4	6	67%	1
120 DKK/hour	6	9	67%	3
200 DKK/hour	7	11	64%	3

Contact channel results:

Contact channel	Count
Private message	15
Comment	8
Friend request + message	3

Fake-door price data connected to MVP 3:

Price field	Numeric answers	Min	Max	Average	Blank / “any”
Poster: pay for task	22	50 DKK	300 DKK	189.5 DKK	5
Poster: pay for instant matching	17	20 DKK	150 DKK	63.5 DKK	10
Seeker: accepted earning	39	50 DKK/hour	200 DKK/hour	107.4 DKK/hour	11

File: MVP3_follow up interview transcription.docx

Purpose:

The follow-up interview was designed to interpret the MVP 3 pricing sensitivity test together with fake-door price findings. It focused on commission from job posters, acceptable commission levels, and how job seekers evaluate acceptable pay across different task types and durations.

Key insights:

Theme	Summary
Commission acceptance	Job posters may accept commission if the platform saves time and helps find someone reliable faster.
Acceptable commission	Around 5–10% is acceptable for small private tasks; up to 15% may be acceptable for urgent matching.
Fixed fee vs percentage	Fixed fee may be clearer for very small tasks, while percentage-based commission makes more sense for larger tasks.
50 DKK/hour	Too low for most tasks unless the task is extremely easy, very close, and takes almost no time.
100–150 DKK/hour	Considered more realistic for one-to-four-hour tasks.
200 DKK/hour	Attractive and may increase response speed, but job seekers still consider trust, safety, distance, and task clarity.
Task duration pricing	Easy micro-tasks can use small fixed payments; one-to-four-hour tasks should be hourly; half-day/full-day tasks need clearer conditions.